

Whitney Kotlewski, PhD

VP of Product | Product Strategy | Portfolio Leadership | AI, Data & Spatial Platforms

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SUMMARY

Product executive with 16+ years inventing and scaling B2B products across AI, data platforms, spatial analytics, 3D digital twins, and mission-critical operations. VP of Product reporting to the CTO—owns vision and multi-product roadmaps, builds AI-powered planning systems, and scales organizations that ship platforms tied to growth.

EXPERIENCE

Slingshot Aerospace, El Segundo, CA

Apr 2024 – Present

VP of Product (2025–Present) · Sr. Director of Product (2024–2025) · Head of Product Design & Research (2024)

- Report to the CTO; scaled the product organization from **3 to 19** across product management, strategy and design, research, customer experience, and space data (US/UK).
- Own SOIA vision and roadmaps; launched **Slingshot Portal** (2026), an AI-native platform for Sense, Fuse, Decide, and Act across space domain awareness, fusion, analytics, and mission decision support.
- Growth window: about **\$124M** capital raised and **\$96M+** in U.S. Space Force awards, including a **\$27M** AI training contract and company-record **\$69.2M** MENTAT SBIR Phase III.
- Built an AI product-strategy knowledge base from ~250 research documents into scored opportunities (~**\$345M**) and regenerable roadmaps for faster planning and board decisions.
- Established first unified design systems: **Nebula** (product) and **Rocket Fuel** (marketing)—~240 tokens and 1,200+ mission-ops components supporting Portal go-to-market.

Matterport, Sunnyvale, CA

Apr 2021 – Oct 2023

Director, Product Design (Platform & Services)

- Joined through a ~**\$2.9B** public listing; led post-IPO product design across eight experiences (web, marketplace, eCommerce, cloud, developer) as revenue grew from about **\$111M to \$158M** and subscribers from about **503K to 938K**.
- Scaled design from **1 to 8** and co-led org growth from **6 to 20**; evolved design systems, accessibility, and research; integrated AI/ML into 3D digital-twin experiences.

Esri, Redlands, CA

Oct 2014 – Apr 2021

Head of UX Innovation (2019–2021) · Co-Founder / Director, Black Girls MAPP (2019–2021) · Design Lead & Sr. UX Architect (2014–2019)

- Led product and UX innovation in a GIS platform business growing from about **\$1.1B to \$1.3B+** revenue across mobile navigation, Insights analytics, Site Scan, and desktop 2D/3D mapping.
- Founded Black Girls MAPP product and design: a **150+** person initiative that delivered 24 maps, 24 layers, 59 apps, and 10 civic products; recognized with the 2021 AAG Diversity & Inclusion Award.

Also Executive Design Advisor, Sonara (2022–2023), about 80x subscription growth; Adjunct Professor, Claremont Graduate University, Design for Good Incubator (2024–Present); CX Lead, Pacific Life (2014); UX Lead / Instructor, IUPUI (2010–2013).

EDUCATION

PhD, Information Systems & Technology Claremont Graduate University, 2017–2024 (AI / data visualization dissertation; patent pending)

MS, Informatics Indiana University–Purdue University Indianapolis

MS, Human-Computer Interaction and **BA** Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute

CORE COMPETENCIES

Product Vision and strategy, roadmap prioritization, OKRs, discovery through delivery, go-to-market, org scaling

Innovation AI knowledge-base operations, opportunity sizing, Nebula and Rocket Fuel, zero-to-one platforms

Domain AI/ML, data visualization, spatial/GIS, 3D digital twin, B2B software, mission intelligence

RECOGNITION

AAG Diversity & Inclusion Award (2021); *GIS for Science Technology Showcase*, Vol. 3, Esri Press (2023); PhD dissertation (ProQuest, 2024); patent pending.